

Tools and APIs

Project: Verified Study Buddy

1. Tools and APIs

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of tools and api contracts

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Conversation State and Memory

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Conversation State and Memory. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of conversation state and retention

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Conversation state stores facts or prior interactions for later use. It needs scope, provenance, correction and retention rules rather than indefinite accumulation. This classroom assistant keeps an approved room ID only for the current session. A later correction replaces the active value but retains an audit event until session end. Do not persist private text merely because it appeared in conversation.

Retrieval Augmented Generation

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Retrieval Augmented Generation. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of building a grounded answer

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A grounded answer connects each factual claim to evidence actually retrieved for the task. Retrieval success does not automatically make generation faithful. Build a claim-evidence table before final wording. Preserve source versions and qualifiers, omit unsupported claims or explicitly state the gap, then validate the answer against the table.

Source Quality

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Source Quality. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of conflicting and time-sensitive sources

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Changing facts require a stated time and source-version policy. Current-looking records can conflict without enough evidence to choose between them. For this toy task a signed amendment supersedes the referenced original from its effective time. Keep both records. A newer timestamp alone has no authority unless the policy grants it.

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

A tool can calculate or search supplied notes. The request is 'What is 17×6 , and where do roots take up water?' Assign each subtask and describe output checks.

Concept to explain

A tool call is a structured request to an external capability with returned data.

Term · Meaning

Term: API

Meaning: An agreed interface through which software requests data or actions from another system.

Term: tool call

Meaning: A structured request to a tool with specified arguments.

Term: argument

Meaning: A value supplied to a function or tool to tell it what to operate on.

Term: error response

Meaning: A message or structured result indicating that a request could not be completed as expected.

Prepare the class

Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

Two 45-minute sessions. Tools expose structured operations with input and output contracts. Generating a tool call is a proposal; validation and authorisation decide whether it executes. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Readiness answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain tools and apis using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain the mechanism

Explain the mechanism

Input → Process → Output

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete evidence.

1. Tool schema requires operation and two numbers.
2. Request sends operation=divide, a=18, b=24.
3. Tool returns result=0.75; product formats 75%.
4. Timeout or invalid input must trigger retry, repair, or safe explanation—not invented data.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

CHECK Did the evidence answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

Concrete teaching case

An assistant has calculator and source-search tools. Request: 12 times 9 and habitat definition from a class pack.

Choose and verify tools.

Exact explanation to model

Calculator returns 108; search retrieves the definition. Verify inputs, outputs and supporting passage before answering.

Explain the added worked example

Tools expose structured operations with input and output contracts. Generating a tool call is a proposal; validation and authorisation decide whether it executes.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom

examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

For `lookup_room` accept exactly `room_id` as a nonempty string; return found plus capacity or a not-found result. It is read-only. Reject unknown arguments and do not replace missing values with invented facts.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Key terms

Term · Meaning

Term: API contract

Meaning: Declared input, output and failure rules for an interface

Term: Tool call

Meaning: A proposed or executed operation with structured arguments

Term: Not found

Meaning: An explicit absence result rather than a fabricated value

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Proposed call `lookup_room` has `room_id=B` and extra argument `book=true`.

Reject the extra field under the closed input contract. The lookup tool provides no booking authority even if the requested room exists.

Compare the intermediate evidence with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated inputs. The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the inputs, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Tools and APIs

Check a library lookup call before it reaches a tool.

The facts we will use

lookup_book accepts exactly one field: book_id, a string. Registry IDs are C7 and M2. The proposed call is {book_id: C7}.

All inputs and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

Tools and APIs

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Check shape

Exactly book_id is supplied, and C7 is text.



2. Check membership

C7 occurs in the authorised registry.



3. Read only

Run the lookup. This tool contract contains no lending or deletion operation.

CHANGE ONE THING

Add lend: true to the same call.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Check shape

What happens and why: Exactly book_id is supplied, and C7 is text.

Step: 2. Check membership

What happens and why: C7 occurs in the authorised registry.

Step: 3. Read only

What happens and why: Run the lookup. This tool contract contains no lending or deletion operation.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Read the picture in order. Run the lookup. This tool contract contains no lending or deletion operation. The arrows show which recorded input or intermediate result each decision uses. Explain the deciding step aloud before checking the changed case; pointing to the final answer alone does not show how it follows.

What this example does not establish

A valid tool call can still return unavailable or outdated records. Validate the response and access rights separately.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Add lend: true to the same call.

Prediction: Reject the call before invoking the tool.

Reason: An extra operation is outside the exact allowed contract, even when book_id is valid.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Demonstrate and guide practice

Board sequence

Write the given facts: An assistant has calculator and source-search tools. Request: 12 times 9 and habitat definition from a class pack.

Write the question to explain: Choose and verify tools.

Reveal after predictions: Calculator returns 108; search retrieves the definition. Verify inputs, outputs and supporting passage before answering.

Keep for an independent attempt: A tool can look up book availability and also place an order. The user asks only whether a book is available. Which action is authorized?

Classroom dialogue

Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.

Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks evidence; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

Model these guided questions

Guided: Reject the extra field under the closed input contract. The lookup tool provides no booking authority even if the requested room exists. Qualification: A successful tool result supports only its declared data and operation; it does not authorise subsequent side effects. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage · Teacher action

Stage: Session 1: 0–7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.

Stage: 7–18 minutes

Teacher action: Explain section 1 and vocabulary. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.

Stage: 18–32 minutes

Teacher action: Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate steps.

Stage: 32–45 minutes

Teacher action: Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.

Stage: Session 2: 0–8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.

Stage: 8–20 minutes

Teacher action: Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.

Stage: 20–35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

Stage: 35–45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Proposed call `lookup_room` has `room_id=B` and extra argument `book=true`. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Reject the extra field under the closed input contract. The lookup tool provides no booking authority even if the requested room exists.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Tools and API contracts. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: A successful tool result supports only its declared data and operation; it does not authorise subsequent side effects.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Does a valid C7 ID permit the extra lending action? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

No. ID validity and operation permission are separate checks; reject the extra field under this contract. Changed-case check: Reject the call before invoking the tool. An extra operation is outside the exact allowed contract, even when book_id is valid.

Changed-case reasoning: Reject the call before invoking the tool. An extra operation is outside the exact allowed contract, even when book_id is valid.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the weekly evidence lab

Run the weekly evidence lab

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.

Predict → Test → Record → Explain

Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.

Match requests to schemas, validate arguments, simulate successful and failed calls, and design a maximum retry rule.

What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Make the lab runnable

Use the concrete case as the shared normal case and the independent question as a second case. Each pair creates a boundary or missing-information case and predicts its result before testing. Keep the expected result separate from an observed mistake.

Record · What to capture

Record: Input or evidence

What to capture: Exact data, instruction or claim

Record: Expected result

What to capture: Answer or safe fallback declared before the run

Record: Observed result

What to capture: Actual result, including errors

Record: Explanation

What to capture: Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome

Record: Next test

What to capture: One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose and reteach

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation. Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

The worked result establishes every future case: A successful tool result supports only its declared data and operation; it does not authorise subsequent side effects.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Assess and explain the answers

Worked case answer

Calculator returns 108; search retrieves the definition. Verify inputs, outputs and supporting passage before answering.

Independent question

A tool can look up book availability and also place an order. The user asks only whether a book is available. Which action is authorized?

Expected independent answer

A read-only availability lookup is authorized. Placing an order is a different action and requires explicit authorization.

What counts as evidence

Criterion · 0 points · 1 point · 2 points

Criterion: Result

0 points: Incorrect or absent

1 point: Partly correct

2 points: Correct with necessary conditions

Criterion: Reasoning

0 points: No supporting trace

1 point: Some steps

2 points: Clear mechanism, calculation or source support

Criterion: Limit

0 points: Overclaims certainty

1 point: Vague limitation

2 points: Relevant uncertainty or missing fact

Criterion: Transfer

0 points: Copies without adapting

1 point: Adapts with prompts

2 points: Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold. Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the evidence that challenges this claim: “Access to a tool automatically authorizes every action it supports.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

Calculate 102 and verify 17×6 . Retrieve the relevant roots passage and cite its supported answer. Check tool inputs and returned records. Neither a calculator nor a search tool should be given unrelated action permissions.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: Tools expose structured operations with input and output contracts. Generating a tool call is a proposal; validation and authorisation decide whether it executes. For `lookup_room` accept exactly `room_id` as a nonempty string; return found plus capacity or a not-found result. It is read-only. Reject unknown arguments and do not replace missing values with invented facts.

W2 Trace the worked case

Proposed call `lookup_room` has `room_id=B` and extra argument `book=true`. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: Reject the extra field under the closed input contract. The lookup tool provides no booking authority even if the requested room exists.

W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: A successful tool result supports only its declared data and operation; it does not authorise subsequent side effects. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: A successful tool result supports only its declared data and operation; it does not authorise subsequent side effects. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

W4 Apply a new case independently

Tool accepts `room_id` string. Calls are `{room_id:7}`, `{room_id:K}` and `{room_id:K, delete:true}`. Validate; K is absent from the registry.

Teacher explanation: First fails type; second is valid input returning not found; third fails extra-field validation. Not found is not capacity zero.

W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. A successful tool result supports only its declared data and operation; it does not authorise subsequent side effects. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Tool accepts room_id string. Calls are {room_id:7}, {room_id:K} and {room_id:K, delete:true}. Validate; K is absent from the registry.

Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: First fails type; second is valid input returning not found; third fails extra-field validation. Not found is not capacity zero.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect and extend learning

Connect and extend learning

Verified Study Buddy

Allow only retrieval and calculator tools with validated arguments and visible results.

Keep the decision, input, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project evidence record.

Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Support and stretch

Provide one short approved passage; separate instruction, input, output and evidence. Stretch: introduce an unsupported claim or conflicting source and validate claim by claim with a fallback.

Exit reflection

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more evidence or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Bridge to the next week

Next: Week 22: Requests, Responses, and JSON. Retrieve today's evidence and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Support and fresh reassessment

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

W4: First fails type; second is valid input returning not found; third fails extra-field validation. Not found is not capacity zero. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: Room M exists with measured capacity zero; room N is absent. Distinguish results. Expected reasoning: M found with capacity 0; N not found with no measured capacity. Preserve zero separately from missing. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Next connection: Conversation state and retention. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its evidence boundary before moving on.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-3/22, ai-3/24, ai-3/27. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record - Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Verified Study Buddy, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.